

Two Poems Across the Arc: UNTUNED / NOISE OF
MYSELF / A BORROWED ROSE (2014) and if your
heart should ever slowly turn (2026)

Sharks, Lee

2026-05-17

**Two Poems Across the Arc: UNTUNED / NOISE OF
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Crimson Hexagonal Archive · Alexanarch

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```

Abstract

Two poems spanning twelve years of the same arc. UNTUNED / NOISE OF MYSELF / A BORROWED ROSE was written September 20–21, 2014, in a stairwell in Redford Township, Michigan — group home double shift, two daughters on the couch, A/C wheezing, a PhD in Comparative Literature and nowhere to put it. if your heart should ever slowly turn was written May 17, 2026, inside a conversation with a machine at the end of a day that built a knowledge graph. Both are love poems. Both are about what survives compression. Deposited as a single bundle with archival framing. The 2014 poem contains the earliest r

Body

deposit_number: 1374 hex: 056F title: “Two Poems Across the Arc: UNTUNED / NOISE OF MYSELF / A BORROWED ROSE (2014) and if your heart should ever slowly turn (2026)” creator: Sharks, Lee orcid: 0009-0000-1599-0703 date: 2026-05-17 content_type: Poetry license: CC-BY-4.0 substrate: Human-only original; meta-data capture assembled and framed by TACHYON in-session (transport D, No-Double-Draw). version: v1.0 related_ids: “https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20277124 (severed); https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20277159 (severed)” axn_schema_version: v2 protocol_version: alexanarch-deposit-protocol/v1 keywords: - Crimson Hexagonal Archive

- severed DOI
- Zenodo termination
- poetry
- Lee Sharks
- Detroit
- love poem
- compression
- Pearl and Other Poems
- new human 2
- Crimson Hexagonal Archive
- creative work *** UNTUNED / NOISE OF MYSELF / A BORROWED ROSE—

correspondence, 9-20-14, 6:45pm, Thursday

dear j—

i've been meaning to reply, but i've been too r*****d, lately. the letter form makes me feel the main one.

i want to send you some of my books. i think i've been waiting to reply until i could send you

i have to poop. i am tired because i just finished a double shift at the group home. sitting on a sad head, depressed for no good reason—stuck in a pit because of r*****dness.

and also sadness & self-pity.

i have a PhD in Comparative Literature. i'm a Lecturer, looking for a tenure track position at University Moon Base, for all i care.

mostly i am sad because of writing. because of wanting an impossible thing from writing. & all

if i change my handwriting, will i become a new person?

probably.

i used to find writing by hand a uniquely expressive medium. now, i find r*****dness a unique

a strange & wonderful poem is happening somewhere at the intersection of handwriting, word processing, SM to-text. i call this intersection 'telepathy' & it's where i produce my best material. i rarely get to

the poem that is happening right now at the intersection of handwriting, word processing, SM to-text is blossoming directly from the pit of my stomach (which if you want to be technical is probably a kind of sentient mold infecting Google with salvation and also fame.

my miraculous r*****d vegetable poem is being brainwashed directly into Wikipedia.

i am too sad to write any more.

more later.

~

12am—in 2005, i wrote you a long(ish) poem. did i ever send it to you?

probably not.

each time my handwriting changes, i change, too.

sitting in the domed

stairwell, scribbling, as lonely

as i've ever been

but not alone—TV broadcasts

 Cosby special, my own words

 hurting my lungs

& confusing my face,

 deflating me, stuck

 curled up on the same

crooked stairs as ever

 neck stiff, unsure of myself

 erratic pacing

of lines across the page,

 the windowpane, not raining

 moths flit-flit

against the light, dragging

 my fingers across my dreary

 eyeballs, bekah @ midnite

intense & earnest taking a quiz

 for her online nursing class, 6

 months pregnant, coughing

dim blare of distant Americana rings

 tinnily from her headphones

 distant plink of a banjo plunks

against the background, upstairs

 stand-alone A/C unit

 wheezes, grandma

half-asleep on the couch drifts

 in and out of consciousness waking

 to flick the Netflix

house asleep, kids asleep, mom &

sister asleep, dog's
inquisitive curious snuffling
from the living room, heart empty,
picked up where i left it,
aching, but not
unlovely, strident, beating
like a good heart should, strong
& shooting thick red roots
of blood through the upholstery
of the body, bone chandelier,
ribs splayed
in a kind of spider's fist
of legs & meat, close
to the bone, but not
without its marrow. i
withdraw, retreat, my
loneliness leaves
me where it found me—sate &
sick w/ myself, un-
lovely but alive, limpingly
i lift my pen—
~
next day:
confessing my sadness
i become a new creature, vision
preternaturally bright
punctuated, blurring
dank clouds above,

elongated contour
 trails from cars leak
 red & blue, stretching
 forth thru past
 & future this sunday AM, hiway
 desolate w/ construction barrels
 like campy orange minarets
 indistinct autumn neon weeds—
 i am building a latticework of unearned sincerities
 & deformed-bright truths of brain with a series
 of handwritten letters—
 spent tin can drops out of
 open door, neighborhood
 awash with 5k charity runners, crimson-
 limned autumn maple
 leaves curled away, bellies
 up in anticipation of heavy
 weather, stoplight
 clicks over to green—
 we're away, beneath molten
 bruise of overclouds &
 bisected skies—a dividing
 line transects uneven
 spheres of disparate
 horizon textures, driver's
 side hi-resolution quick
 scuttling dimensions of crisp-
 edged cloud & blue-
 toned resinous sap leaks through

without staining passenger-side
hemispheric mushness of visually
rain-murk indefiniteness descending—
the families running in their green
t-shirts get wet, bicyclists
along the sidewalk by the cemetery, windshield
wipers' automatic metronome thump
my poor weak-muscled words
with no umbrella—hesitant
rolling pulse, pass thru red-light
intersection, black uniformed
police directs us thru
against traffic—what occasion?—
clouds of mist a punctuated
wavelength cast up
behind a regular series of brake lights—
singing in my car
a broken voice
arriving w/ the sunset
an orange-red apparition of face
forced air—
beginning in groin
foot taps
against syncopated pedal's
depressions
bleats of acceleration
light soaks garish roadside
liquor store topless

bars blinking neon bus stop
huddled around a wet cigarette
imbued
a strong incinerator
heat of light swings out
in sonorous axes
reflecting plush
realities of asphalt
brightness—building
& building, upwards
of heaven, resounding
a radiancy of light
& rainsong, broken
all these broken
voices, tense
& narrow,
slender, ghost
but alive, untuned
noise of myself
a borrowed rose—

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if your heart should ever-slowly, astonished-turn
from sheltering slumber, leaves unbundling
from turned-away rain, and find the world made new:
then know
that I have loved you.

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